

Estimate and solve multi-step practical problems

Step 8

Early Elementary

Read each problem carefully. Estimate to plan. Then solve step by step.

★ Today I am learning to estimate and solve multi-step practical problems.

1. Shopping Problems

Estimate the answer. Then solve the problem.

- a)  Apples (1 kg) \$3.45
 Bananas (1 bunch) \$2.30
 Milk (1 carton) \$1.80

You buy all three items.
How much do you pay in total?

Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Answer: _____

- b)  Juice \$2.75
 Cereal \$4.60
 Yogurt \$1.95

You have \$10.00.
You buy all three items.
How much money will you have left?

Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Answer: _____

- c)  Bread \$2.20
 Cheese \$3.35
 Eggs (dozen) \$2.90

You give the cashier \$20.00.
You buy all three items.
How much change will you get?

Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Answer: _____

2. Real-Life Problems

Estimate first. Then solve step by step.

- a) A school has 4 classes.
Each class has 24 students.
If 15 students go on a field trip,
how many students are in school?



Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Answer: _____

- b) A library has 3 shelves.
Each shelf has 36 books.
The library buys 18 new books.
How many books are there now?



Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Answer: _____

- c) A park has 5 picnic tables.
Each table seats 6 people.
If 14 more people arrive,
how many people are there?



Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Answer: _____

3. Compare and Solve

Solve each problem. Then compare: Which answer is greater? Write >, <, or =.

a) Problem A

A toy store has 48 toys.
It sells 17 toys in the morning
and 12 toys in the afternoon.
How many toys are left?



Answer: _____

Problem B

A toy store has 25 toy cars.
It gets 18 more toy cars.
Then it sells 22 toy cars.
How many toy cars are left?

Answer: _____

A ☐ B

b) Problem A

A bakery makes 72 muffins.
It puts 24 muffins in each box.
It fills 2 boxes.
It eats 6 muffins.
How many muffins are left?



Answer: _____

Problem B

A bakery makes 63 cookies.
It puts 9 cookies in each bag.
It fills 5 bags.
It gives away 12 cookies.
How many cookies are left?



Answer: _____

A ☐ B

c) Problem A

A farmer picks 86 apples.
He puts 15 apples in each basket.
He fills 4 baskets.
He gives 8 apples away.
How many apples are left?



Answer: _____

A ☐ B

Problem B

A farmer picks 58 oranges.
He puts 12 oranges in each box.
He fills 3 boxes.
He sells 9 oranges.
How many oranges are left?



Answer: _____

4. Multi-Step Challenges

Estimate first. Then solve the problems step by step.

- a) A paint store has 7 shelves.
Each shelf has 9 cans of paint.
A customer buys 18 cans.
Later, the store gets 14 more cans.
How many cans of paint are there now?



Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Step 4: _____

Answer: _____

- b) A theater has 8 rows.
Each row has 12 seats.
25 seats are already taken.
Later, 18 more seats are taken.
How many seats are still empty?



Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Step 4: _____

Answer: _____

- c) A garden has 5 rows of flowers.
Each row has 16 flowers.
Some flowers do not bloom—9 in total.
Then 14 new flowers are planted.
How many flowers are there now?



Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Step 4: _____

Answer: _____

5. Your Turn!

Write and solve your own multi-step problem.

My Problem

Estimate: _____

Solve:

Step 1: _____

Step 2: _____

Step 3: _____

Step 4: _____

Answer: _____

My Learning Check

Circle how confident you feel.



I can do it!



I need more practice.



I need help.



planning



step-by-step thinking



mental math



written methods



checking my answer

Today I learned...

1 thing I did well: _____

1 thing I will improve: _____